

2c. Content of Drama: Performance and response (04)

For this component, learners need to demonstrate knowledge and understanding of how drama is developed, performed and responded to.

Learners must also be able to reflect on and evaluate the work of others.

This component is designed for learners to explore practically and in depth both a whole performance text and the development of drama and performance. They are then assessed on the knowledge, understanding and skills they have learnt.

Through their practical study, learners need to know how characters and performances communicate ideas and meaning to an audience.

The component has two sections: The study of a performance text and the development of drama and performance in Section A and an evaluation of the work of others in Section B.

For section A, learners are required to study **one** performance text from the following:

The performance texts for examination until **2028** are:

- *Blood Brothers* - Willy Russell
- *Death of a Salesman* - Arthur Miller
- *Find Me* - Olwen Wymark
- *Gizmo* - Alan Ayckbourn
- *Kindertransport* - Diane Samuels
- *Missing Dan Nolan* - Mark Wheeler
- *Misterman* - Enda Walsh

Learners are not permitted to have access to the text in the examination.

All of these set texts cannot be performed for assessment in the 'Presenting and performing texts' component.

The set texts will be reviewed after three years and may be subject to change. If a text is to be removed from the list and replaced with another text, centres will be notified a year in advance.

Learners are also required to study the development of drama and performance for Section A.

For Section B, learners will be required to have seen a live theatre performance. They will be required to analyse and evaluate the performance.

Learners **cannot** answer questions using the same performance text for Section A **and** Section B in the examination.

At the start of the learner's answer they must state the name of the performance, the venue, and the date (month and year) the performance was seen.

Details on what can be reviewed in this section can be found in Appendix 5e.

Drama: Performance and response		
Learners should:	Learners must know and understand:	Learners should be able to:
in Section A: study a whole performance text.	in relation to their performance text: - the contexts of their chosen text including: - social - historical (time set and period written) - cultural - the theatrical conventions of the period in which their text was created - the characteristics of their performance text including: - genres - structure - characters - form and style - theatrical setting (place) - plot and subplot - dialogue - stage directions - how meaning is communicated through: - the use of performance space and spatial relationships on stage - the relationship between performers and audience - the design of: set, props, costume, lighting and sound - an actor's vocal and physical interpretation of character - the use of performance conventions.	- define how the social, historical and cultural contexts have an effect on the chosen performance text - explore and identify the characteristics of a text through practical preparation work and be able to explain the impact they have on a performance text - select examples from their own practical study which demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the full range of characteristics of the performance text - identify how a range of genres may have been used to inform the characteristics of the performance text - identify how meaning is communicated within the performance text - evaluate the roles that theatre makers (from contemporary professional practice) have on developing, performing and responding to a performance text.
in Section A: study the development of drama and performance.	- contemporary staging including: - apron - black box	evaluate the roles that theatre makers (from contemporary professional practice) have on developing,

Learners should:	Learners must know and understand:	Learners should be able to:
	◦ proscenium arch ◦ site specific ◦ thrust ◦ traverse • the role of theatre makers in contemporary professional practice, including: ◦ actors ◦ choreographer ◦ costume designer ◦ director ◦ lighting designer ◦ lyricist ◦ playwright ◦ set designer ◦ sound designer ◦ stage managers ◦ understudy • Acting skills including: ◦ blocking ◦ characterisation ◦ improvisation • vocal techniques an actor might use to communicate a role • communication through physicality and the use of body language, facial expression and gesture • the use of semiotics • the design and use of a set including: ◦ composite sets ◦ non-naturalistic sets • the development of character through the creation and use of: ◦ costume ◦ hair and makeup ◦ masks	• state advantages and disadvantages for the decisions made directing, acting and designing for a performance • apply knowledge and understanding of the development of drama and performance to the studied performance text.

Learners should:	Learners must know and understand:	Learners should be able to:
	• The use of contemporary light, sound and media technology in contemporary performance • how performance styles affect the direction, acting and design of a performance. • the features of a performance text including ◦ acts and scenes ◦ antagonist ◦ character ◦ dialogue ◦ duologue ◦ flashback ◦ monologue ◦ plot and subplot ◦ protagonist ◦ stage directions	
• in Section B: analyse and evaluate the work of others through watching live drama and theatre.	• the meaning of drama and theatre terminology used by theatre makers • how genre is used in live performance to communicate meaning to an audience • how to analyse a live theatre performance • how to evaluate the work of others, drawing considered conclusions.	• select and use appropriate subject-specific terminology • discuss, analyse and evaluate how meaning is created and communicated through live theatre using their knowledge and understanding of drama • analyse and evaluate the acting, design and the characteristics of the performance text seen.